

Budget Saudi Arabia – rental requirements and policies

What a customer needs, and the rules before, during and after a rental

Compiled from Budget's public websites (budgetsaudi.com, budget.com and the Budget country sites), checked 25 September 2026. Points marked **General practice** are common Saudi or Gulf rental practice, not a published Budget rule: the branch or the reservations team confirms them.

Documents needed to collect a car

Budget Saudi asks customers to bring all of the following when collecting a vehicle:

- **Driving licence.** Saudi citizens, Saudi residents (iqama holders) and GCC nationals show their **local driving licence**. All other nationals show an **international driving licence** (international driving permit) together with their national licence.
- **A major credit card in the renter's own name**, for the deposit. Even with a prepaid voucher, a deposit is taken on the credit card. Cash, cheques and debit cards are usually not accepted.
- **The reservation confirmation** (reservation number).
- **Passport plus one other form of identification.** Saudi citizens show their national ID and residents their iqama. Visitors show their passport with a valid visa.
- Any discount, coupon, loyalty card or corporate identification, shown on arrival.

Every driver must be present at the counter with a valid licence. Budget screens for high-risk drivers and may ask about a renter's driving record; a rental can be refused if the record does not meet Budget's criteria.

Age and licence

- Budget Saudi's loyalty programme requires members to be **at least 21**. **General practice** in Saudi Arabia: a renter must be at least 21, and at least 25 for luxury cars; the licence should have been held for at least one year.
- **General practice:** visitors may drive in Saudi Arabia on a valid foreign licence with an international driving permit for a limited time after entry; the reservations team confirms which licences are accepted for the customer's nationality.

The electronic rental contract (Tajeer)

Since 2021 every car rental contract in Saudi Arabia is a unified electronic contract issued on the **Tajeer** platform of the Transport General Authority (TGA). The renter needs a valid ID, a driving licence valid for the whole rental, and must confirm the contract with a verification code sent to the mobile number registered on **Absher** (citizens and residents). Extensions and closing the contract are also recorded electronically.

Booking, changing and cancelling a reservation

- Book by phone on **920004124**, on www.budgetsaudi.com, in the Budget Saudi app or at a branch.
- Existing bookings can be viewed, changed or cancelled under **Manage booking** on budgetsaudi.com, or through reservations on 920004124. The reservation number and the renter's name are needed.
- A reservation (confirmed or not) is not yet a rental contract. The contract is made at the time of rental and follows Saudi law.
- Budget's online booking system states: cancelling a **pay-on-arrival** booking is free; for a **prepaid** booking, the refund (less administration charges) goes back to the card used, and a cancellation email is sent. Cancelling in advance avoids a no-show fee.
- A car category is reserved, not an exact make and model; Budget cannot always guarantee a particular model.

- Things to check when booking: whether the rate includes unlimited mileage, the damage excess, VAT (15% in Saudi Arabia), airport location surcharges, one-way fees (different pick-up and return locations), cross-border fees, and extras such as child seats or GPS.

Extending a rental

General practice: to keep the car longer, the customer contacts Budget **before the agreed return time** (920004124 or the branch). The extension depends on the car being available, the rate may change for the new length of rental, and the Tajeer contract is extended electronically. Returning late without an agreed extension leads to extra charges, as the rental agreement says.

Returning a car early

General practice: a car can be returned before the agreed date. The rental is then recalculated on the days actually used, so a weekly or monthly rate may no longer apply, and prepaid days are not always refunded. The customer should tell Budget before returning early and return the car at the agreed branch unless Budget agrees otherwise.

Collecting the car

- The car should be ready on arrival, clean and mechanically sound. Tell a member of staff before leaving if it is not.
- The customer signs a **pre-rental inspection form** showing existing scratches and dents. Walk around the car and have any extra damage added before accepting it: new damage found at return is charged to the customer.
- Check the tyres, wipers, washer fluid, lights, horn, the spare wheel and tools, and the fuel level against the paperwork.
- Check the fuel type: the wrong fuel damages the engine, and the customer pays for cleaning the engine and the loss of use.

Fuel options

The car normally comes with a **full tank**. Some locations offer three fuel options:

- **Option 1 – prepay the fuel** and bring the car back empty. The tank is charged at, or sometimes below, the current pump price. No credit is given for unused fuel.
- **Option 2 – full to full:** take it full and bring it back full, to avoid refuelling service charges. Recommended when you plan to stop for fuel.
- **Option 3 – pay for what you use:** Budget refuels after return at the location's per-litre refuelling service charge.

During the rental

- **Only the drivers named on the rental agreement** may drive the car. Additional drivers are added at the counter (they must be present with their licence).
- **Damage cover:** the renter is responsible for loss and damage until the car is returned and inspected. Collision/Loss Damage Waiver (CDW/LDW) and Theft Waiver reduce the renter's liability to the **excess** shown on the agreement. Check exclusions (for example windscreen, tyres or roof damage).
- **Traffic fines** (speeding, parking, Saher cameras) during the rental are the renter's responsibility; Budget may add an administration fee.
- **Cross-border travel:** Budget Saudi offers cross-border rentals, but the car may only leave Saudi Arabia with Budget's prior permission and the insurance required by the other country. Ask when booking.
- Off-road driving breaches the standard terms and damages tyres.

Breakdowns, accidents and emergencies

Budget Saudi 24-hour roadside assistance: 800 244 3399 – for a breakdown or any help on the road in Saudi Arabia, 24 hours a day, 7 days a week.

- **If anyone is injured or in danger:** call **911** (unified emergency number) or 997 ambulance, 999 police, 998 civil defence (fire), 993 traffic accidents.
- **Accident without injuries:** report it to **Najm** (920000560 or the Najm app); Najm handles minor accidents where no one is hurt.
- After an accident: do not admit responsibility to anyone involved; take the names and addresses of everyone involved and any witnesses; call Budget straight away; complete an accident report form when returning the car.
- Breakdown: call 800 244 3399. Budget arranges help, towing or a replacement car.

Returning the car

- Return the car at the agreed time and place, in the same condition, with the agreed fuel level. Late or different-place returns cost extra unless Budget agreed.
- Have a Budget employee inspect the car with you and sign for any damage on the agreement. Allow extra time at busy airport branches.
- Out-of-hours return: the renter stays responsible for the car until Budget inspects it. Park safely and legally and take photos inside and out. Budget recommends returning during opening hours.
- Damage may be charged using a pre-calculated repair estimate or the actual repair cost; if the car cannot be rented, a loss-of-use charge may apply.

After the rental: charges and complaints

Charges for damage or traffic offences can arrive after the rental. To dispute one, ask Budget for the supporting documents. Post-rental questions and complaints go to Budget Customer Care:

bccc@budgetsaudi.com or +966 12 692 7070 ext. 1463 (Sunday to Thursday). Budget aims to resolve queries within 5 to 30 days. Billing disputes are handled by Budget staff, not by an automated assistant.